

BLUEBELL LAKE INN

Who poured the last cup of tea?



A COZY MURDER MYSTERY PARTY GAME

The
Something Blue
MURDER

A Cozy Bachelorette & Bridal Shower Murder Mystery

6-14 PLAYERS · 90 MIN-2.5 HOURS · PRINTABLE PDF

HOST GUIDE

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Everything you need to run The Something Blue Murder, even if you have never hosted a mystery before. This guide never reveals the answer, so you can play along.

How the game works

1. **Everyone gets a character booklet.** The Guest of Honor always gets booklet 10 and plays the Lead Detective. Everyone else is a suspect.
2. **Three rounds:** Something Old (past grudges), Something New (fresh discoveries) and Something Borrowed (things borrowed or moved). Each round you read a short script and hand out four evidence cards.
3. **Guests mingle,** share what their booklet tells them to share, ask two named characters a question and try a small social mission.
4. **Final Questions and the vote.** The Guest of Honor asks three people one question each, then everyone fills in a ballot.
5. **Something Blue.** The Guest of Honor opens file 99 and reads the reveal aloud. You score the ballots and hand out awards.

Your job as host

- Send invitations and hand out booklets (the casting chart on page 4 tells you which).
- Keep time, read Scripts 1–4 and hand out the evidence envelopes.
- Keep things moving and make sure quiet guests get asked questions.

CAN THE HOST PLAY?

Yes. Take booklet 12 or booklet 15 for yourself (see the casting chart) and play like everyone else. Or simply narrate. Ask another guest or family member to cut the evidence cards and fill the envelopes, so you have not seen them either.

DON'T OPEN YET

File **99-SOLUTION-Open-Last** holds the answer. Don't open it, don't print-preview it. Print it face down or keep it on a phone for the Guest of Honor.

Preparation Checklist

2 WEEKS → PARTY DAY

Two weeks before

- ☐ Pick the date and the edition: Evening (2½ hours) or Shower (90 minutes).
- ☐ Confirm your guest count (6–14, including the Guest of Honor).
- ☐ Use the casting chart (page 4) to choose the booklets.
- ☐ Decide whether you will play (booklet 12 or 15) or narrate.
- ☐ Send invitations (file 02, or the text version on its last page).

One week before

- ☐ Send each guest their character name and booklet number, or the booklet PDF.
- ☐ Share the Cast List (file 03) so people can plan costumes.
- ☐ Plan mocktails and snacks (page 13).
- ☐ Buy envelopes, pens, tape or pins, and a blue teacup prop if you like.

Your party plan

DATE

EDITION (EVENING / SHOWER)

GUEST OF HONOR

HOST PLAYS BOOKLET 12, 15 OR NARRATES

Two or three days before

- ☐ Print the files on the print list in file 00.
- ☐ Ask a helper to cut the evidence cards and fill three envelopes: Round 1 (E1–E4), Round 2 (E5–E8), Round 3 (E9–E12).
- ☐ Print booklets single-sided; cut along the dashed line on page 3 if you like.
- ☐ Cut name tags, ballots, table tents and banner pennants.
- ☐ Seal file 99 in an envelope marked “Guest of Honor: open last.”

On the day

- ☐ Hang the WHO DID IT? banner; set the Bluebell Lake Inn table tent.
- ☐ Set an “Evidence” table with its tent card.
- ☐ Lay out name tags, booklets (folded or in envelopes), pens and detective notes.
- ☐ Chill the mocktails; set out the snacks.
- ☐ Keep this guide and the three evidence envelopes beside you.

START TIME

NUMBER OF PLAYERS

CARD-CUTTING HELPER

BALLOT BOX

Casting Chart

6-14 PLAYERS

Count everyone who will hold a booklet, including the Guest of Honor and you (if you play). Booklets are added in number order.

PLAYERS	BOOKLETS TO USE	HOST MAY TAKE
6	10-15 (the six core booklets)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
7	10-16 (adds Kendall Brooks)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
8	10-17 (adds Remy Okafor)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
9	10-18 (adds Tatum Reyes)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
10	10-19 (adds Shiloh Park)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
11	10-20 (adds Marlowe Gray)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
12	10-21 (adds Peyton Lowe)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
13	10-22 (adds Hayden Cruz)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane
14	10-23 (adds Lennox Bell)	12 Reese Calloway or 15 Dakota Lane

HOW TO CAST

Booklet **10** always goes to the Guest of Honor. Hand out every other booklet however you like: any character can be played by anyone, and every booklet uses names and “they,” never he or she.

MORE THAN 14 GUESTS?

Let couples or best friends share a booklet as a duo. With fewer than 6, try our free 4-6 player mini mystery, *The Case of the Cold Cocoa*.

Timetables

EVENING · SHOWER

Evening Edition · 150 minutes

For a bachelorette or hen party night at home or a vacation rental.

PART	MINUTES
Arrival, name tags, mocktails	15
Script 1 (opening) and reading page 2	15
Round 1 · Something Old	25
Round 2 · Something New	25
Snack break	10
Round 3 · Something Borrowed	25
Final Questions (Guest of Honor)	10
Ballots	10
Something Blue: reveal and awards	15
Total	150

Shower Edition · 90 minutes

For a daytime bridal shower. Fits neatly before or after gift opening.

PART	MINUTES
Welcome and name tags	5
Script 1 and reading page 2	10
Round 1 · Something Old	15
Round 2 · Something New	15
Round 3 · Something Borrowed	15
Final Questions	10
Ballots	5
Something Blue: reveal	10
Awards and photo	5
Total	90

SHOWER SHORTCUTS

Skip the snack break, keep missions quick, and let guests read page 2 while the mocktails are poured.

Your party clock

Write in real clock times for your party, so you know at a glance when to start each round.

GUESTS ARRIVE

SCRIPT 1

ROUND 1 STARTS

ROUND 2 STARTS

ROUND 3 STARTS

FINAL QUESTIONS

BALLOTS

SOMETHING BLUE

RUNNING LATE?

Every round still works in 15 minutes. Cut the snack break first, then shorten Rounds 2 and 3. Never skip Final Questions: it is the Guest of Honor's big moment.

The evidence envelopes

Ask a helper who is not the Guest of Honor (and not you, if you are playing) to cut the evidence cards from file 30. If you print the card backs on the reverse, they can cut face down. They sort the cards into three envelopes:

- **Round 1 envelope:** E1, E2, E3 and the gold-framed E4.
- **Round 2 envelope:** E5, E6, E7 and the gold-framed E8.
- **Round 3 envelope:** E9, E10, E11 and the gold-framed E12.

The gold-framed cards are marked “For the Guest of Honor.” In each round you hand that one to the Guest of Honor to read aloud and place the other three on the Evidence table.

The room

- One “Evidence” table where everyone can read the cards without taking them.
- The round table tent for the current round, turned to face the room.
- A ballot box: any bowl, hat or teapot.
- A quiet corner where people can read their booklets privately.

The booklets

Put each booklet in an envelope with the character’s name, or hand them out at the door. Remind everyone: page 1 is safe to read at any time; page 2 waits until Script 1; page 3 and page 4 wait for the rounds. If you cut page 3 along the dashed line, hand out the Round 2 half when Round 2 starts.

HOST TIP

If guests are arriving in waves, hand booklets out as they arrive and let early birds chat about costumes and the Cast List. Start Script 1 when everyone has a name tag.

Script 1 • Opening

READ ALOUD

Read this when everyone has a name tag and a booklet. Take your time; pause for gasps.

READ ALOUD

Welcome, everyone, to Bluebell Lake Inn, and to a weekend in honor of our wonderful Guest of Honor! This afternoon we all gathered in the tea room for a welcome tea. In charge of every detail was Celestine Marchbanks, known to all as Cece, the most famous wedding planner on the lake. At lunch, Cece announced that she would drink her chamomile from the Guest of Honor's heirloom blue teacup, the family's very own "something blue." At 3:30 the tea was poured, and Cece sipped and smiled for the photos. At 4:15 Cece said, "I feel terribly sleepy; wake me for dinner," and went upstairs to rest.

At 5:45, Cece did not answer the door. When Emerson unlocked it, Cece had passed away, peacefully, in her sleep. The village doctor, Dr. Ames, has been and gone, and says this was no accident. The last ferry has left, so nobody leaves the lake tonight. Everyone here had a reason to be at that tea, and more than a few of you had a reason to be cross with Cece.

Our Guest of Honor will lead the investigation as Lead Detective. Please open your booklet and read page 2 quietly to yourself now. Do not turn to page 3 until I start Round 1. Innocent characters may dodge questions about their secrets until their booklet says to share; only the person responsible may lie outright. Nobody may change what an evidence card says. Ready? Let's find out who poured the last cup of tea.

AFTER READING

Give everyone about five minutes for page 2. Then start Script 2.

Script 2 · Round 1

SOMETHING OLD

Turn the “Something Old” tent to face the room. Open the Round 1 envelope.

READ ALOUD

Round one: Something Old. Every family keeps a few old things, and so did Cece: old contracts, old columns and old grudges. Please open your booklet to page 3 and read the top half, Round 1, only. I am placing three pieces of evidence on the Evidence table: numbers one, two and three. Read them, but leave them there for everyone.

And now, a Guest of Honor Clue. Guest of Honor, please stand and read Evidence number four aloud. Everyone else, listen closely: the Guest of Honor will only read it once, and it may matter more than you think.

You have about twenty-five minutes. Share what your booklet tells you to share, ask your two questions and try your mission. Find someone you do not know yet and start there. Good luck, detectives.

HOST NOTES

- Hand E4 to the Guest of Honor; put E1–E3 on the Evidence table.
- Give a five-minute warning before the round ends.
- If a corner goes quiet, ask: “Who has asked you a question yet?”

Script 3 · Round 2

SOMETHING NEW

Turn the “Something New” tent to face the room. Open the Round 2 envelope.

READ ALOUD

Round two: Something New. While you were all busy accusing one another, there have been new discoveries. The doctor has sent a note about exactly what was in that teacup, and something small has turned up in the tea room. Please read the lower half of page 3, Round 2. Do not turn to page 4.

I am placing Evidence five, six and seven on the Evidence table. Read them closely; times matter tonight. Guest of Honor, please read Evidence number eight aloud. Everyone, think hard about who could have been near that cup, and when.

You have about twenty-five minutes. Ask your two questions, share your new information and try your mission. If someone dodged you in Round 1, ask them again.

HOST NOTES

- Hand E8 to the Guest of Honor; put E5–E7 on the Evidence table.
- Evening Edition: after this round, take a ten-minute snack break.
- Encourage people to fill in the timeline on their Detective Notes.

Script 4 · Round 3

SOMETHING BORROWED

Turn the “Something Borrowed” tent to face the room. Open the Round 3 envelope.

READ ALOUD

Round three: Something Borrowed. Something in this inn was borrowed this afternoon, something was moved, and someone has been telling a story that does not quite fit. Please turn to page 4 of your booklet and read Round 3.

I am placing Evidence nine, ten and eleven on the Evidence table. Guest of Honor, please read Evidence number twelve aloud, slowly. This is the last evidence of the night, so look at all twelve cards together. You have about twenty-five minutes: ask, share, and try your final mission.

Final Questions

When Round 3 ends, gather everyone. The Guest of Honor may ask any three people one question each, about the evidence. Answers must be honest about what the evidence shows.

READ ALOUD

Detectives, it is time to vote. Please take a ballot and write who did it, how and why, and up to three evidence numbers that prove it. No conferring. Fold your ballot and drop it in the ballot box. When every ballot is in, our Guest of Honor will open the sealed solution.

HOST NOTES

Hand E12 to the Guest of Honor; put E9–E11 on the table. Allow about ten minutes for Final Questions and ten for ballots.

How to Reveal

SOMETHING BLUE

1. **Collect every ballot.** Keep the ballot box closed.
2. **Hand the sealed file 99 to the Guest of Honor.** Page 1 says STOP. That is fine: every ballot is in.
3. **The Guest of Honor turns straight to page 4, Script 5,** and reads it aloud to the room. Script 5 reveals who did it and explains the clues.
4. **Let the person responsible take a bow.** Applause is mandatory.
5. **Score the ballots** with the scoring rules on page 5 of file 99 (and on every ballot): Who 3 · How 2 · Why 2 · up to 3 evidence points.
6. **Give the awards** from file 34: Best Detective (highest score), Best Performance and Best Dressed (vote by applause).

READ ALOUD (BEFORE THE REVEAL)

Every ballot is in. Guest of Honor, the truth is in your hands: please open the solution and read us Script 5. Everyone else, keep your theories to yourselves for one more minute.

TIES

If two detectives tie on points, the one who named the most evidence numbers wins. Still tied? The Guest of Honor decides.

PHOTO MOMENT

Line everyone up behind the WHO DID IT? banner with the person responsible in the middle and the Guest of Honor holding the blue teacup.

When two friend groups don't know each other

- **Start with the missions.** The Guest of Honor's and Blair's Round 1 missions are about guests who have never met, and Script 2 tells everyone to start with someone they do not know yet.
- **Mixed pairs.** Before Script 1, ask each guest to find someone from the other group and swap "how do you know the Guest of Honor?" stories.
- **Seat by character, not by friendship.** Put name tags at the table so groups mix naturally.
- **Use the named questions.** Every booklet tells players exactly whom to ask, so nobody has to think of an opener.

Keeping it moving

- Give a five-minute warning before each round ends.
- If someone is stuck, ask them to read their "Share" lines aloud to the room.
- Quiet guest? Ask the Guest of Honor to put a question to them in Final Questions.
- Running late? Shorten Rounds 2 and 3 to 15 minutes each; the clues still fit.

Keeping it kind

- The game is PG and clean: no drinking tasks, no flirting, nothing gory. Grandparents and coworkers welcome.
- Let the Guest of Honor shine: they read the gold cards, ask the Final Questions and read the reveal.
- Nobody has to act. Reading a line straight from the booklet is perfectly fine.

Mocktails & Snacks

ALL ALCOHOL-FREE

Three alcohol-free drinks and three easy snacks that suit a lakeside tea. Make them your own.

Mocktails

- **Something Blue Lemonade:** butterfly pea flower tea and lemonade, which turns from blue to violet when stirred.
- **Blueberry Lavender Fizz:** blueberry syrup, a little lavender and sparkling water over ice.
- **Iced Chamomile Cooler:** chilled chamomile with honey and lemon, in honor of the famous cup.

Snacks

- **Cucumber tea sandwiches:** crustless, cut into fingers, perfect for mingling.
- **Blueberry scones:** with jam and cream for a proper lakeside tea.
- **Blue and white macarons:** bought or baked, stacked on a cake stand beside the Evidence table.

SERVING TIP

Serve drinks in mismatched teacups and keep one blue cup on the Evidence table as a prop (empty, of course).

ALLERGIES

Ask about allergies when you send invitations, and label each snack.

Vacation Rental Packing List

AIRBNB · LAKE HOUSE · CABIN

Hosting away from home? Pack this kit so the game works anywhere.

The game

- ☐ Printed booklets in named envelopes
- ☐ Evidence cards in three round envelopes
- ☐ Sealed file 99 (or on the Guest of Honor's phone)
- ☐ This Host Guide
- ☐ Ballots and Detective Notes
- ☐ Name tags and the Guest of Honor badge
- ☐ A pen for every guest, plus spares
- ☐ Tape, safety pins or name tag holders

The party

- ☐ Banner pennants, string and a few clothespins
- ☐ Table tents and award certificates
- ☐ A blue teacup prop
- ☐ Mocktail syrups and a drinks dispenser
- ☐ Paper napkins and plates
- ☐ A small speaker and a playlist
- ☐ Phone chargers
- ☐ A bowl or hat for ballots

NO PRINTER AT THE RENTAL?

Print everything at home before you travel. Booklets also read fine as PDFs on phones; just ask guests not to scroll ahead.

Printing & Folding

LETTER OR A4

- **Paper size:** use the US-Letter or the A4 folder to match your paper. Print at “Actual size” or 100%.
- **Black and white is fine.** Every round and card type is marked in words, not only color. Color looks lovely if you have it.
- **Booklets (10–23): print single-sided.** Then page 3 can be cut along the dashed line so Round 2 is handed out separately, and later rounds can’t show through.
- **Evidence cards (30):** pages 1–2 are the cards; page 3 is optional card backs. To use them, print page 3 on the back of pages 1 and 2 and let your helper cut face down.
- **Name tags (31), ballots (32), awards and decor (34):** cut along the dashed lines; fold tents on the dotted lines.
- **Detective Notes (33):** one copy per player.
- **Ballots (32):** one sheet for every four players.
- **Solution (99):** print it last and face down, or keep it on the Guest of Honor’s phone. Never print-preview it.

CARD STOCK

Name tags, table tents and awards look best on light card stock (65–80 lb / 170–220 gsm). Everything else prints on ordinary paper.

BOOKLETS ON PHONES

Every booklet is its own PDF, so you can text it to a guest. Ask them to read only page 1 before the party.